WP 06. Semiconductor Plasma Etch Uniformity and Selectivity Mapping

RESEARCH STATUS	Proposed study. No experimental results have been claimed.
CLUSTER	Semiconductor Manufacturing
EXCEL CROSSWALK	Not specifically listed
CLOSEST PROJECT	paceval_Industrial_Piecewise_Calibration

Abstract

Etch process recipes need rapid, interpretable evaluation of wafer-scale response under varying pressures, chemistry and electrode temperature. This study defines a falsifiable and independently testable mathematical kernel for the paceval. Mathematical Engine. The workload and the evaluation criteria below are experimental plans rather than measurements.

1. Industrial scope and relationship to existing research

Distinctive contribution: Spatially varying etch rate, selectivity and wafer uniformity, not generic piecewise calibration.

Workbook relationship: Not specifically listed. The workbook index and potential commercial benefit are subjective estimates, not measured commercial evidence.

2. Candidate mathematical kernels

Kernel 1

```
Rate surrogate: r = r0*exp(-Ea/(Rg*T))*(P/P0)^a*(1+b*x*x+c*y*y)
```

Kernel 2

```
Selectivity: sel = r_film/max(r_mask,eps)
```

Kernel 3

```
Depth: d = r*t_etch
```

Kernel 4

```
Uniformity deviation: delta = (r-r_center)/r_center
```

Model expressions are mathematical specifications, not syntax-checked SDK strings. Implementation must declare units, parameter domains, formula IDs, regularization, model assumptions and reference tests.

3. How paceval is actually used

The host application owns parsing and dimensional validation of inputs, formula versioning, candidate generation, dataset provenance, graph-handle lifetime, independent solvers, aggregation and output. paceval owns every supported explicit scalar or composite mathematical expression and its repeated evaluation. Expression creation is performed once per stable model version. The host reuses each computation handle for all compatible input rows. Batch evaluation is used only where it preserves semantics and actually improves measured throughput. The selected paceval SDK or MCP interface must be identified in the experiment log; a local SDK call is not reported as a remote MCP benchmark.

C++ orchestrates candidate enumeration, fitted coefficients, domain-specific numerical solving, independent checking and I/O. paceval should own all supported scalar, composite cost, sensitivity and constraint formulas. Stable models use persistent computation handles and batch execution when beneficial.

4. Proposed numerical experiment and comparators

Evaluate 1e6 radial and angular wafer points over 25 recipe versions and parameter perturbations.

Baselines: Compare with scalar C++, SIMD C++, and a measured wafer map or trusted plasma-process simulation if available.

Collect median, p95 and p99 latency across repeated runs; throughput, peak RAM, graph creation time, time per reused evaluation, energy where measured and complete pipeline wall time. Record hardware, compiler, precision, parallelism, batching, runtime version, warmup, data layout and input-sequence checksum. Use identical mathematical expressions, tolerances and unit handling in every baseline. Baseline alternatives should include optimized native C++ and, where domain-relevant, specialist solvers. Invalidate claims of engine-wide speedup if the measured advantage exists only in a small formula stage.

5. Independent validation and edge cases

1. Confirm positive rates and stable selectivity at small mask rates.

2. Hold out wafer locations and compare uniformity RMSE to reference metrology.

3. Stress etch-time extremes and temperature extrapolation.

Predeclare the accepted absolute, relative and application-scaled errors. Verify each expression against an independent implementation using the same inputs and conventions. Include singular, limiting, invalid and near-boundary cases. If a formal interval claim is made, demonstrate coverage of an entire input interval using a method that actually bounds the interval; pointwise TINC checks alone are not such a proof.

6. Go or no-go assessment

A pilot is a technical go only if it passes the independently stated numerical and application acceptance tests and demonstrates either a repeatable improvement of at least 15% in full-pipeline latency or energy under matched conditions, or at least 25% reduction in measured formula-update/integration effort without a performance or quality regression. These are proposed decision thresholds, not measured outcomes. A result below the threshold is a no-go for the claimed benefit, even if the mathematical engine functions correctly.

Principal risk: The rate law is a compact surrogate, not plasma kinetics or equipment-model identification.

7. Required release artifacts

Provide C++ sources, runtime version, formula manifest, dataset or synthetic generator with fixed seeds, native and high-precision references, failed-case logs, confidence intervals for timings and complete pipeline resource measurements. Never claim deployment, customer validation or certification without separate evidence.

8. Selected external references

1. https://www.nist.gov/laboratories/tools-instruments/nanofab-tool-oxford-plasmapro-100-inductively-coupled-plasma-icp-iii

2. https://www.nist.gov/laboratories/tools-instruments/nanofab-tool-bruker-dektak-xt-profilometer

paceval architecture: https://paceval.com/developers/

Context sources do not certify any paceval results.